

OVERVIEW

Microsoft Audience ads allow you to immerse your brand within publisher sites to reach the right audience, at the right time, within the right context. This winning combination drives engagement, click-through rate (CTR), cost per acquisition (CPA) and more to enhance your campaign performance.

Getting started is simple.

- For Image Based Ads: Upload an image, copy and a URL and Microsoft Advertising formats your content to match the unique look and feel of the publisher site, whether it's displayed on a smartphone, tablet, or laptop.
- For Video & Connected TV ads: Upload your video creative, adhering to our video quality ratings that are outlined below. The quality of your video will determine where your ads can serve – the higher the video quality, the more premium placements you will be able to access. Note, Video & Connected TV ads are currently in open beta; so, they may not be available yet to all advertisers. Please get in touch with your account team to know more.

IMAGE BASED AD DELIVERABLES

Ad components	File type	Dimensions
Image	JPEG or PNG	Recommended: 1200x628 or higher. Minimum: 703x368.
Short headline	Text	40 characters max
Long headline	Text	90 characters max
Ad text	Text	90 characters max
Business name	Text	25 characters max
URL	Text	1024 characters max
Mobile URL	Text	1024 characters max

BEST PRACTICES FOR AUDIENCE ADS

- You only need one wide (rectangle) image, sized at **1200×628** pixels – but we recommend at least 3 to start.
 - Use high-quality JPG or PNG image files.
- Images are recommended to have **no text or logo overlay** for maximum flexibility.
 - Some publishers prohibit the use of embedded text within images. Text overlay can be repetitive with your ad copy and may be cut off when images are resized.
- Putting text into headlines and descriptions is always recommended. If text is required in the image (e.g., legally required/logo issues):
 - Naturally integrate necessary text into the center of the image
 - Use fewer words.
 - Use smaller font size.
 - Be sure to leverage the ad preview tool to check your ad experience.

- The image must be **clearly relevant to the product** or service being advertised.
- Before submitting, ensure images and text look as expected in all preview formats using the **ad preview tool** in the UI and ensure that there is no text overlay.
- Image assets used for Audience Ads share the same dimensions as Google Display Ads, Facebook Ads and Yahoo Gemini.

TIPS FOR CHOOSING GREAT IMAGES

Your creative assets are what potential customers see first. Make sure you're curating the most impactful imagery.

- Choose photos that your audience can relate to, are **relevant to your ad**, and fit with your brand.
- Use **multiple images**. We recommend at least 3 images per ad. Rotate in new images regularly to avoid fatigue.
- Avoid clutter and ensure important visual elements – **particularly people** – are centered in your image assets.
- Pick **lifestyle photos**, like a woman running, instead of just a picture of a running shoe. Show products being used.
- Utilize **bright and inviting color palettes**. Vibrant colors will help create focus and interest in your ads.
- Choose **compelling images**. People shown experiencing an emotion, increase impact.

SAFE AREA

Publishers place "sponsored" or "ad" icons typically near the bottom of the image along with the headline and business name text. This should be considered when choosing image content.

Audience ads support individual image cropping to support all aspect ratios for each ad experience. Use of the preview tool is important to validate each ad experience. If your ad is not showing as expected in each aspect ratio, you can re-crop it.

View example placements



2.01 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio

Exclude

Microsoft Edge Carousel

2 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio

Exclude

Microsoft Audience Network Banner

1.91 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio

Exclude

Microsoft Audience Network River

1.69 : 1 aspect ratio

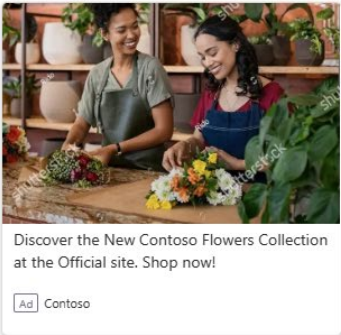
Edit aspect ratio

Exclude

MSN Carousel

1.53 : 1 aspect ratio

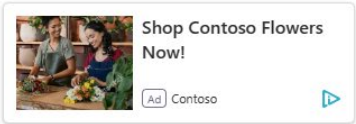
Edit aspect ratio
Exclude



MSN Partner Stripe

1.24 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio
Exclude



MSN Restoday

1.2 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio
Exclude



Microsoft Audience Network Rectangle

1 : 1 aspect ratio

Edit aspect ratio
Exclude



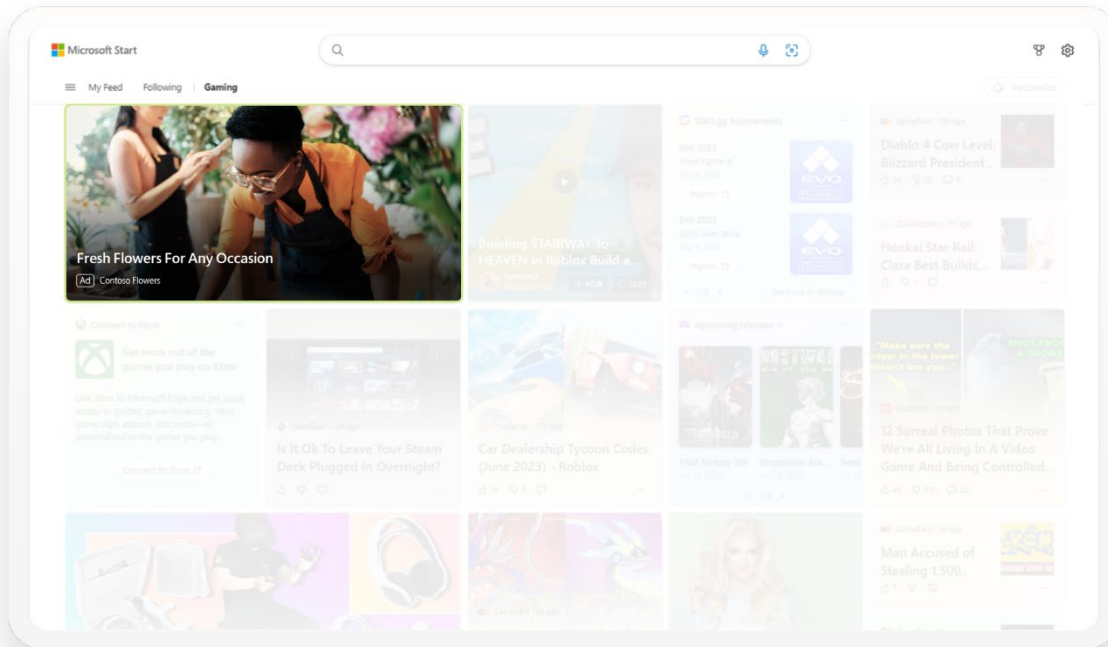
Microsoft Edge Mobile

This is an example of how your ad could appear on other websites in the Microsoft Audience Network. The final ad format is likely to change to match the look and feel of the website.

Last updated – March 2024

EXAMPLE

Microsoft Start homepage PC web



VIDEO BASED AD DELIVERABLES

With Video & Connected TV ads, advertisers can reach their audience across a wide range of online video and Connected TV inventory. To access more premium online video and CTV inventory, advertisers need to upload higher quality assets.

Video assets are categorized in three ways: Fair Quality, Good Quality and Excellent Quality

Once you upload your videos to Microsoft Advertising, the system will determine which quality standards your video meets using a three-star rating, with three stars being the highest.

Use the below guidelines to understand what the requirements are for each of the different video qualities. If you wish to advertise on our most premium inventory, ensure that your video meets the excellent quality requirements.

*Denotes a required attribute, all other attributes are recommended for best results.

Attribute	Fair Quality   	Good Quality   	Excellent Quality   
File size limit	2 gigabytes for video creatives (max size)	2 gigabytes for video creatives (max size)	2 gigabytes for video creatives (max size)
Video file type*	MP4, MOV, WEBM, MKV, VOB, OGV, OGG, AVI, QT, WMV, RM, ASF, M4P, M4V, MPG, MP2, MPEG, MPE, MPV, M2V, 3GP, 3G2, SWF, TS	MP4, MOV MP4 format is preferred.	MP4, MOV MP4 format is preferred.
Video bitrate*	2,500+ kbps	8,000+ kbps	15,000+ kbps for MP4 42,000+ kbps for MOV (720p) and 80,000 kbps (1080p) for MOV (Apple ProRes)
Video resolution*	960 x 720 1280 x 720 1440 x 1080 1920 x 1080	1280 x 720 1920 x 1080	1280 x 720 1920 x 1080
Video duration*	The duration must be between 6 and 60 seconds.	The duration must be between 6 and 60 seconds.	The duration must be either 15 or 30 seconds.

	We recommend videos to be one of the following: 6 seconds (minimum), 15 seconds, 30 seconds, 45 seconds, 60 seconds (maximum)	We recommend videos to be one of the following: 15 seconds, 30 seconds.	
Video frame rate	23.976, 24, 25, 29.97, 30 fps	23.976, 24, 25, 29.97, 30 fps	23.976, 24, 25, 29.97, 30 fps
Audio bitrate	128+ Kbps	192+ Kbps	192+ Kbps
Audio format	Audio sample rate: 44.1 or 48 Khz	Audio sample rate: 44.1 or 48 Khz	Audio sample rate: 48 Khz
Aspect ratio	4:3, 16:9	16:9	16:9
Audio sample size	N/A	N/A	16 or 24 bits
Audio channels	N/A	N/A	Two (stereo)
Audio codec	N/A	N/A	PCM or AAC-LC
Track conformance	N/A	N/A	File should contain only 1 video and 1 audio track
Duration conformance	N/A	N/A	Video and audio track durations should match with tolerance of 500 ms

POLICIES AND GUIDELINES

[Microsoft Audience Ads policies](#)

[Microsoft Advertising policies](#)

[Microsoft native creative acceptance policy](#)